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Glossary

shrug - raise one's shoulders slightly and momentarily
tunic - a loose outer garment without sleeves
slackened - reduced
demeanour - appearance and behaviour
artless - innocent, guileless
hawk - sell things crying out loudly, going from place to place
deserted - uninhabited, unoccupied
emigrate - take up citizenship of another country
vexation - annoyance
vestibule - lobby
chatter - a series of short, quick high-pitched sounds
intrude - enter without permission
rubble - debris, broken bricks

1. Answer the following questions in one or two sentences each based on your understanding of the story.

a) Who did the narrator meet at the outskirts of Verona?

b) Why did the driver not approve of the narrator buying fruits from the boys?

c) The boys did not spend much on clothes and food. Why?

d) Were the boys saving money to go to the States? How do you know?

e) Why did the author avoid going to Lucia's room?

f) What was Lucia suffering from?

g) What made the boys join the resistance movement against the Germans?

h) What made the boys work so hard?

i) Why didn't the boys disclose their problem to the author?

2. Answer the following questions in three or four sentences each.

a) Describe the appearance of Nicola and Jacopo.

b) What were the various jobs undertaken by the little boys?

c) How did the narrator help the boys on Sunday?

d) Who took the author to the cubicle?

e) Describe the girl with whom the boys were talking to in the cubicle.

f) Recount the untold sufferings undergone by the siblings after they were rendered homeless.

g) The narrator did not utter a word and preferred to keep the secret to himself. Why? Substantiate the statement with reference to the story.

3. Answer the following in a paragraph of 100–150 words each.

a) What was the driving force that made the boys do various jobs?

b) How was the family affected by the war?

c) Write a character sketch of Nicola and Jacopo.

d) What message is conveyed through the story 'Two Gentlemen of Verona'?

e) Justify the title of the story 'Two Gentlemen of Verona'.

f) Adversity brings out the best as well as the worst in people. Elucidate this statement with reference to the story.

g) Which character do you like the most in the story and why?

12th General_English_Unit_1_A_Prose.indd 5 07-12-2021 17:50:54